

97 Superlative adjectives

Superlative adjectives, such as “the biggest” or “the smallest,” are used to talk about extremes. Long adjectives take “most” and “least” to show an extreme.

See also:

Articles 63 Adjectives 92

Comparative adjectives 94

97.1 SUPERLATIVE ADJECTIVES

For most adjectives with one or two syllables, “-est” is added to make the superlative.

Horses are faster than dogs,
but cheetahs are **the fastest** land animals.

The comparative describes the difference between two things.

The definite article (“the”) is always used before the superlative.

The superlative describes which thing is the most extreme.



FURTHER EXAMPLES



Giraffes are **the tallest** animals in the world.



Blue whales are **the largest** animals in the world.



Sloths are **the slowest** animals in the zoo.



Dolphins are **the smartest** animals in the world.

HOW TO FORM

SUBJECT + VERB

Cheetahs are

“THE” + SUPERLATIVE

the fastest

REST OF SENTENCE

land animals.